

damage from dust or water. This makes them perfect for individuals with active lifestyles or those prone to accidental bumps and tumbles (like me).

Whether you're an outdoor enthusiast or simply clumsy, the candybar phone offers peace of mind. Foldables, while gradually improving in durability, still raise concerns. True, some of these come with IP ratings, but it is often not a high rating such as IP68 as one would see on flagship

Credit: JerryRigEverything (YouTube channel)



phones such as the latest Samsung Galaxy S24 Ultra. Foldable phones' hinges and folding mechanisms are potential weak points, and the larger, thinner screens are generally more susceptible to damage. Additionally, the folding display usually is a mix of glass and plastic, which gets scratched pretty easily. Not to forget that the potential repair costs for foldables can be significantly higher.

FORM FACTOR FRENZY

In terms of form factor, the choices couldn't be more contrasting. Candybar phones offer a familiar, pocket-friendly design that easily fits into any pocket or bag. This makes them ideal for situations where quick access and one-handed operation are crucial.

Foldables, on the other hand, sacrifice pocketability for versatility. They are thicker and bulkier when folded, which can be inconvenient for carrying around. While they offer a tablet-like experience when unfolded, they require two hands to operate effectively in this state. This can be a deal-breaker for users who prioritise one-handed use or require their phone to be readily accessible in their pocket.

HARDWARE HINDRANCES

While foldables boast a cutting-edge form factor, they often face limitations in other crucial hardware components due to their

compact folded state. To maintain that size, manufacturers often compromise on other elements. Notably, cameras in foldables tend to be inferior to those found in high-end candybar phones. The space constraints in foldables limit the size and quality of the lenses, which can result in lower image and video quality compared to their candybar counterparts. It is also a lot rarer to see foldables with high-quality periscope lenses because of how much room they require.

Similarly, battery life in foldables can suffer. The larger display can often lead to shorter battery life compared to candybar phones. This can be particularly frustrating for users who rely on their phones for extended use throughout the day.

PRICING PARADOX

The pricing structure of these two phone types reflects their target audiences. Candybar phones are significantly cheaper than their foldable counterparts – for example, a foldable with a less powerful SoC can be priced the same as a candybar phone with the latest and greatest processor. This makes candybar phones an attractive option for budget-conscious individuals or those who prioritise affordability over cutting-edge form factors, multitasking, and content consumption.

For users looking for a reliable phone for communication and light entertainment, candybar phones offer an excellent value proposition. Conversely, foldables represent the pinnacle of mobile innovation and come with a hefty price tag. They are targeted towards early adopters and tech enthusiasts willing to shell out a premium for the latest advancements in mobile technology. If you crave the novelty and innovative features of a foldable, be prepared to pay a significant price.



BEYOND THE BASICS

While the core aspects of multitasking, content consumption, durability, form factor, hardware, and pricing provide a solid foundation, there are additional considerations to factor in:

Software Optimisation: Foldables are still a relatively new, and software optimisation is still evolving. Some apps and games may not be fully optimised for the larger, foldable display, leading to potential glitches or awkward UI scaling. Candybar phones, with their established form factor, generally benefit from mature and well-optimised software experiences.

Ecosystem Integration: Foldables, as a relatively niche product category, may have limited accessory options compared to candybar phones. Cases, chargers, and other peripherals may be more readily available and affordable for candybar phones due to their larger user base.

Aesthetics and Personal Preference: Ultimately, personal preference plays a significant role in the decision-making process. Some users might find the innovative design of foldables appealing, while others might favour the familiarity and practicality of candybar phones. Consider which form factor resonates more with your typical phone usage patterns.

TAILORING YOUR CHOICE

Choosing between a candybar phone and a foldable phone boils down to understanding your individual needs and priorities. If you prioritise affordability, durability, the latest camera hardware, and one-handed use, a candybar phone might be the perfect fit. If you value a larger screen for multitasking and content consumption, a foldable phone might be worth considering. However, be prepared for the higher price point and potential drawbacks like software optimisation until the technology fully matures. That being said, the foldable market is growing at a tremendous rate, and the technology is evolving faster than one could imagine. So, whether you choose a reliable classic or embrace the innovative future, the choice ultimately depends on what matters most to you in your mobile experience. 